

31% foreign now, 38% by 2030?

A business statement, tested against Eurostat, NSO and Jobsplus data

THE CLAIM

**“foreign residents now make up 31% of Malta’s population”
“...potentially reaching around 38% by 2030.”**

PwC Malta, Summer 2026 Economic Update press release, The Malta Business Weekly, 19 July 2026

The 38% is “the mix of foreign to local residents”, from PwC’s own demographic model.

“Foreign” is not defined in the release; the 31% matches the count of non-Maltese citizens.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

**31% is right;
38% by 2030 not shown.**

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

31%

Right for end-2025

Eurostat’s figures give 30.9–31.1% non-Maltese citizens on 1 January 2026; 29.4% a year earlier.

32.0%

Higher by birthplace

Residents born abroad on 1 January 2025 (Eurostat). Definitions change the figure.

39.8%

Higher still in jobs

Foreign nationals’ share of registered employment, December 2025 (Jobsplus).

38%

PwC’s own model

We found no Eurostat or NSO projection by citizenship. PwC’s report could not be read.

–1,832

What 38% would need

Fewer Maltese citizens each year to 2030, at PwC’s 636,000. Their number rose every year 2010–2024.

FAIR TO SAY

PwC’s current figure is right, and it labels the 2030 figure as a projection (“potentially”, “around”). This check asks only whether the 38% can be shown from published data.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ How “foreign” and “local” are defined for 2030.

☐ The base-case local population for 2030.

☐ The share at 624,000 and at 660,000.

☐ The NSO’s end-2025 table by citizenship.